

..e) David Schneider idea of symbols

David Schneider belongs to Chicago school of culture and wrote "American Kinship: A Cultural Account".

IDEA of Symbols:-

He said symbol is "something that stands for something else". He said culture is

"set of symbols with meaning".

His ideas are :-

a) Symbols and their meanings should be studied to unravel culture of people.

b) an EMIC perspective of an insider view aids better ethnography.

Culture is in mind of culture bearers

c) He said RELATION between symbols need to be studied.

Difference from idea of Geertz:-

Geertz studied symbols of daily usage. David Schneider states that such symbols do not give holistic picture.



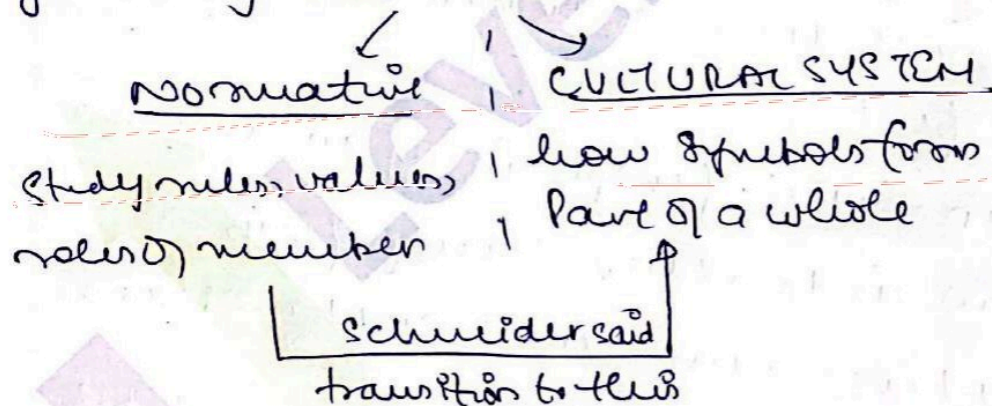
Difference from idea of Turner:-

David said even unobservable symbols should be studied.

[Eg] Belief system and spirits don't have physical presence but relation of spirits to others can be done.

STUDY OF KINSHIP :-

He said "Kinship is a system of symbols and meaning". [2] levels of study in culture



④ He associated this to other symbols like political, food, clothing etc

Criticisms Talan Assad says such studies are tough to replicate. They remain descriptive. Post modernists say TOTAL EMIC can never be got.